

ABC SCHOOL
Sample Educational Institution

Lesson Planning Guidelines

Standards and Templates for Effective Lesson Design

Academic Year: 2025-2026

Edition: Sample Edition

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Table of Contents

1. Purpose	3
2. Lesson Planning Framework	3
3. Required Lesson Plan Components	4
4. Long-Term, Medium-Term, and Short-Term Planning	4
5. Differentiation Strategies	5
6. Integrating Formative Assessment	6
7. Sample Lesson Plan Template	6
8. Cross-Curricular Planning	7
9. Planning for Inclusion	7
10. Lesson Plan Submission and Review	8
11. Common Planning Pitfalls	8

1. Purpose

Effective lesson planning translates the curriculum into purposeful, engaging classroom experiences. This guide sets out the minimum expectations for lesson planning at ABC School and offers a shared framework so that planning quality is consistent across grades and subjects.

These guidelines apply to all teaching staff and should be used alongside the Curriculum Guide, which defines what is taught, and the Assessment Guidelines, which define how learning is measured.

2. Lesson Planning Framework

ABC School uses a four-part framework for individual lesson design, sometimes referred to by the acronym E-A-P-R: Engage, Apply, Practice, Reflect.

Phase	Purpose	Typical Duration
Engage	Activate prior knowledge and introduce the objective	5-10 minutes
Apply	Introduce new content through modeling or guided exploration	15-20 minutes
Practice	Independent or collaborative application of the new learning	15-20 minutes
Reflect	Consolidate learning and check understanding against the objective	5-10 minutes

3. Required Lesson Plan Components

Every lesson plan, regardless of subject or grade, should include the following components, even in brief form for routine lessons.

- Learning Objective: a clear, student-facing statement of what will be learned.
- Success Criteria: observable indicators that the objective has been met.
- Prior Knowledge Link: how the lesson connects to previously taught content.
- Key Vocabulary: subject-specific terms to be introduced or reinforced.
- Resources and Materials: a list of materials, including any digital tools needed.
- Differentiation Notes: planned adjustments for identified groups of learners.
- Assessment Method: how understanding will be checked during or after the lesson.

4. Long-Term, Medium-Term, and Short-Term Planning

Planning Level	Time Span	Owner	Purpose
Long-Term Plan	Full academic year	Subject Coordinator	Sequence of units across the year
Medium-Term Plan	One unit (2-6 weeks)	Class/Subject Teacher	Breakdown of a unit into weekly goals
Short-Term Plan	Single lesson	Class/Subject Teacher	Detailed plan for one lesson

5. Differentiation Strategies

Differentiation should be planned in advance rather than improvised. The table below summarizes common strategies organized by what is being adjusted.

Dimension	Strategy Examples
Content	Tiered reading texts, varied complexity of practice problems
Process	Flexible grouping, scaffolded templates, extended think time
Product	Choice of output format (written, oral, visual) for the same objective
Environment	Quiet workspace options, flexible seating, visual schedules

Differentiation notes in a lesson plan should name the specific group or individual being supported (without using identifying personal details) and the specific adjustment being made.

6. Integrating Formative Assessment

Every lesson should include at least one formative check for understanding, used to inform either real-time adjustments within the lesson or planning for the next lesson. Common low-prep techniques include exit tickets, quick polls, think-pair-share, and cold-call questioning aligned to the success criteria.

7. Sample Lesson Plan Template

Field	Example Entry
Subject / Grade	Mathematics / Grade 4
Learning Objective	Students will be able to add and subtract fractions with like denominators.
Success Criteria	Students can solve 4 of 5 practice problems correctly and explain their reasoning.
Key Vocabulary	Numerator, denominator, like denominators, equivalent fraction
Engage (8 min)	Quick visual fraction puzzle on the board; discuss prior knowledge of fractions.
Apply (18 min)	Model two worked examples using fraction bars; guided practice with the class.
Practice (18 min)	Students work in pairs on a worksheet with differentiated problem sets.
Reflect (8 min)	Exit ticket: solve one problem and explain the steps in one sentence.

8. Cross-Curricular Planning

Where possible, teachers are encouraged to identify natural links between subjects, such as connecting a Science unit on ecosystems with a Language Arts persuasive writing task about conservation.

Cross-curricular planning is coordinated at the medium-term planning stage with input from relevant Subject Coordinators to avoid duplication or scheduling conflicts.

9. Planning for Inclusion

Lesson plans for classes including students with an Individual Learning Plan (ILP) should reference the relevant accommodations directly, rather than relying on memory or informal notes. Class Teachers should consult with the Learning Support Coordinator when planning units that may need significant adaptation.

10. Lesson Plan Submission and Review

Requirement	Detail
Medium-Term Plans	Submitted to Subject Coordinator at least 1 week before the unit begins
Short-Term (Daily) Plans	Kept in the teacher's planning folder; available for review on request
New Teacher Plans	Reviewed weekly by Grade Coordinator for the first full term
Spot Checks	Conducted termly across all grades as part of quality assurance

11. Common Planning Pitfalls

- Writing an activity-focused objective (e.g. 'students will complete a worksheet') rather than a learning-focused one.
- Overloading a single lesson with too many objectives, leaving insufficient time for practice.
- Treating differentiation as an afterthought rather than building it into the initial plan.
- Skipping the reflection phase when time runs short, missing the opportunity to check understanding.